

Alikhan Beisenbayev

Visual Storyteller

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Profile

Cartographer and developer with experience in building aesthetic designs and interactive stories. Three years of production geospatial work, from satellite fire analysis to React map platforms, alongside scroll-driven narratives recognised by the British Cartographic Society. Running map Instagram account, posting innovative 2D and 3D animations, as well as recent natural disaster events for more than 9,000 followers as @tulparmaps on Instagram. Currently finishing an MSc thesis measuring how readers actually behave inside a climate map story.

Selected projects

Scrolling Through the Heat 🔗

Urban heat stress in Vienna

- Interactive climate scrollytelling built and user-tested as MSc thesis research on reader engagement. Stack: React, MapLibre. (20 participants)

Tigranes The Greatest Storytelling 🔗

- Scroll-driven interactive map narrative of the ancient Armenian Empire under Tigranes II. Combined archival cartographic research with web-native data storytelling. Winner of the Armenia Open Data Contest.

Silk Road through Centuries 🔗

- Printed cartographic design showcasing the historical trade network focused on Central Asian routes. Winner of the British Cartographic Society.

Asharshylyq 🔗

- Map tells a story of how dramatic population declined after famine under Soviet Union era of Kazakhstan.

Earth on Fire 🔗

SDG 17 Atlas under UN publishing

- Developed a map of fire alert activity worldwide

Skills

Design: Figma, Mapbox Studio, Blender, Affinity, Adobe Illustrator, DaVinci Resolve

GIS and Remote Sensing: QGIS, ArcGIS Pro, Google Earth Engine, GDAL

Programming: JavaScript, React, D3.js, Python, PostgreSQL, Git

Web Mapping: MapLibre, Deck.gl, Leaflet, Mapbox

Languages: English (fluent), Kazakh (limited proficiency), Russian (fluent), German (A2)

Work Experience

GIS Engineer

Dec 2024 – Feb 2026 | Kazakhstan, Remote

Institute of Ionosphere

- Reported and published an interactive report on 23 years of wildfire change in Kazakhstan, taking it from raw MODIS and VIIRS satellite records through analysis to a finished output.
- Designed and delivered a public wildfire monitoring platform end-to-end, from Figma prototype to React and OpenLayers front end.

Junior GIS Specialist

Sep 2023 – Sep 2024 | Armenia, Remote

Traceair technologies 🔗

- Processed and quality-checked 200+ digital elevation models for a web platform used to monitor active construction sites, improving the accuracy of 3D terrain visualisation.

GIS Analyst KazGISA LLP 	Sep 2023 – Dec 2023 Astana, Kazakhstan
• Cut map load times by roughly 30% on a national public geoportal by moving large vector datasets to Mapbox Vector Tiles. • Maintained the underlying stack: GeoServer, PostGIS, QGIS.	
GIS Lab Technician Geography department at CSULB	Sep 2022 – Jun 2023 Long Beach, USA
• Automated vegetation index processing (NDVI, SAVI, AEVI) for 100+ drone images in Python, halving turnaround for research faculty. • Taught 100+ students spatial analysis in ArcGIS, QGIS and Python; redesigned department web pages in Figma.	
GIS Intern HERE technologies	May 2022 – Aug 2022 Online, Internship
• Built interactive web mapping applications in Leaflet.js and validated base map features at scale.	

Education

Master of Science in Cartography — Erasmus Mundus Scholarship Technical University Munich (TUM) Thesis: Evaluating User Engagement in an Interactive Map-Based Narrative of Heat Stress in Vienna	Oct 2024 – Oct 2026 Munich, Germany
Bachelor of engineering in geodesy, GPA - 3.8/4.0 L. N. Gumyilov Eurasian National University Project: Web-based Satellite Image Analysis for Water Detection using NDWI and Leaflet	Sep 2018 – Jun 2022 Astana, Kazakhstan

Awards

British Cartographic Society · GeoHipster · Winner, Armenia Open Data Contest · Erasmus Mundus scholarship